

The most lucrative

AI-NATIVE TECH ROLE IN 2026

AI FDE Program
with specialization in AI Applications





ABOUT **SCALER**

Scaler (by InterviewBit) is an outcome-focused leading ed-tech platform for tech enthusiasts. We are a transformative tech school devoted to creating a growth ecosystem to assist software professionals in unlocking talent and opportunities at every stage of their career. We've rebuilt our curriculum to make you AI native, integrating real AI tools, workflows, and problem-solving into how you learn. So you don't just keep up with change, you stay ahead of it; ready to build, adapt, and thrive in how engineering actually works today.



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FDEs IN DEMAND

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The role every AI-based enterprise is betting on

The first quarter of 2026 saw every big tech firm including the frontier AI companies investing billions of dollars to on-board and train talent with one specific focus - work within customer organizations to deploy AI solutions and workflows running on real enterprise systems and data frameworks.

OpenAI \$4B

Acquired Tomoro and onboarded 150 FDEs to launch standalone deployment company

Microsoft \$2.5B

Microsoft Frontier Company embeds 6000 specialists into client environments to build, deploy and run their AI models

aws \$1B

Created dedicated FDE organization to build and operate production AI on the customer's own data and governance

ANTHROPIC \$1.5B

Launched Ode with Anthropic placing Applied AI engineers in mid-sized enterprises to redesign workflows around Claude

Indeed job report

729%

increase in FDE hiring posts
from Apr 2025-26

WHY FDEs

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The gap that's driving the gold rush

Indeed job report

95%

Gen-AI pilots drive no significant P&L impact in production environments

The problem - AI-based solutions are falling short after demo testing, when deployed into a client enterprise's systems, legacy data, compliance regimes and everyday users. The result - a sharp increase in global demand for engineers who can ensure the AI model functions accurately without hallucinations when deployed in actual production environments.

The roles in high demand:

Forward Deployed Engineer | Applied AI Engineer
AI Solutions Engineer | AI Implementation Engineer
Embedded AI Engineer

MARKET LANDSCAPE

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Organizations building FDE talent

Frontier AI Labs

OpenAI Google ANTHROPIC sarvam

Enterprise SaaS & Data Platforms



Consulting Firms

McKinsey & Company BCG Deloitte. accenture

IT Service Firms



AI based Startups

emergent lyzr wonderful KRUTRIM

The talent is scarce and the demand is compounding! This makes FDEs the most lucrative role in tech today, with compensations that match the skillset.

UNDERSTANDING THE REQUIREMENT

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Organizations building FDE talent

Going deeper than a typical engineer, an FDE is embedded within a specific client's organization. They don't just deploy an AI-based solution within their production environment, but also ensure it works at scale, flawlessly. The role demands a broad skillset and deep enterprise understanding, applied to a live business environment full of friction - tangled data, ageing systems, wary stakeholders, regulatory limits.

Here's a clear picture of what that includes



WHY SCALER?

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A program built by active FDEs,
for real job-readiness

The global shift in AI-focus from a model economy to a deployment economy led us to design a program that equips the Indian AI-native workforce with the skillset and the mindset to conquer the role. We are here to build engineers with a deep understanding of business systems, AI fundamentals and confidence to present outcomes and defend solutions before actual stakeholders.



Curriculum

Designed by
active FDEs



Mentors

From top tier companies
(Including MAANG)



Projects

Based on real-world
business problems



The FDE Lab

A simulated business
environment to test projects

Test your projects inside one of a kind AI-powered simulation

You build deployment judgment by living the pressure of a live engagement, again and again – not by watching slides. This gives you a realistic understanding of the role beyond the coding and technical knowledge, to enter real business engagements with confidence.

The environment

- Realistic, case-based scenarios – not tidy exercises
- AI-driven customer personas who behave like real stakeholders
- Imperfect data, the way it actually shows up on the job
- Requirements that shift mid-project

The Engagement, Rehearsed in Three Acts

Discovery

- Run discovery and scope the problem
- Face stakeholders who push back and change their priorities

Design

- Architect the solution
- Watch it stress-tested against real constraints

Defence

- Present in a simulated review
- Walk through your trade-offs
- Justify the architecture
- Field the hard questions

BUILD REAL CONFIDENCE

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Live the role with multiple industry-ready projects

You take Meridian Retail from firewalled legacy database to live production platform, shipping a working piece with every module.

The FDE Launchpad:

Engagement docs a real FDE writes in week-1 (site survey, PRD-lite, SOW, ADRs), Meridian's core schema and secure way to reach customer PII stranded in a firewalled legacy SQL Server.

The Ingestion Pipeline

A reliable Python service that pulls nightly order and inventory data out of the legacy system, streaming large exports and validating messy records, tested end to end with pytest.

The Platform Backend

Production-grade order and payments APIs with real-time status over WebSockets, event-driven inventory and the observability to survive real transaction volume.

The Client-Facing Layer

Polished React/TypeScript dashboard that turns raw APIs into something Meridian's ops team can actually run fulfilment on, unified with your own backend into one working app.

The New Ask

Mid-engagement the client wants an AI copilot over their policy docs: you run the discovery call, write the PRD-lite, and ship evaluated, guardrailed RAG into the live product, then demo it to a stakeholder panel.

From Answering to Acting

The copilot stops answering and starts doing: live order lookups, LangGraph orchestration, MCP, CRM and shipping-partner integrations and a human in the loop before any refund goes out.

The Scale Question

"Will this survive 50x traffic on Black Friday?" - load balancing, caching, sharding and queues, redesigned formally and defended to leadership with the client's own architects in the room.

Scaling the AI Layer

The same question for the AI stack: inference serving, vector search at scale, model versioning and rollout, and fleet-wide observability for a copilot serving every Meridian customer.

Prepping the Ground

Hardened Linux hosts, a real network topology, and shell automation for the ops work: the unglamorous layer everything else stands on.

Containerizing Meridian

The whole platform (backend, frontend, AI services) containerised and orchestrated on Kubernetes, deployed by GitOps rather than being configured manually.

Going Live

An actual AWS go-live: VPC, EKS, RDS, caching, DNS and TLS, provisioned with Terraform and shipped through CI/CD, including the cost conversation with the client's CTO.

Making It Bulletproof

Multi-region HA, disaster recovery, sharding at production scale, and graceful degradation, so the platform stays up on the day it matters most.

Enterprise Sign-Off

Security hardening, an incident-response drill, and the runbook and readiness review the client needs before it scales further.

FDE Capstone

New Client, Full Simulation: a fresh brief under compressed time and pressure, red-teamed by your classmates, to prove the skills transfer beyond Meridian discovery through build to a closing Demo Day in front of an industry panel, with the whole engagement packaged into an interview-ready portfolio.

SCALER ADVANTAGE

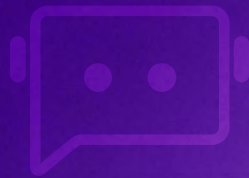
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Fastest route to your dream career

Every feature is designed with one goal, your success.

From curriculum to mentors, projects, placements, every step is carefully considered with nothing left to chance.

This is what makes Scaler different and gives you an edge.



24x7 AI Companion

Always-on learning buddy that uses contextual help & dialogue based solutioning, blending AI speed with mentor expertise.



Unlimited AI Mock Interviews

Real role-based simulations with unlimited practice anytime, structured to match actual MAANG interview journeys.



AI-Powered Resume Builder

ATS-ready resumes powered by 100K+ real profiles; Scaler learners historically have seen 5x more interview calls.



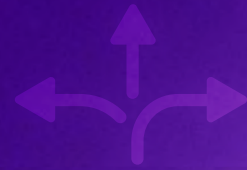
Taught by Industry Leaders

Learn from on-the-job top professionals, not career teachers. Practical insights rated highly by 50k+ learners



Live Classes with Recording

Interactive live sessions with instant recordings & notes for revision.



Expert Mentor Guidance

1:1 personalized advice from top-firm mentors mapped to your profile and career goals.



Monthly Contests

Module-specific tests tied to job readiness, with unlimited attempts for improvement.



Skill Certifications

Rigorous module-level certifications that prove job-ready skills recruiters trust.



Coding Streak

Daily practice streaks with rewards & streak freeze to help you stay consistent.



Extend into Master's Degree

Scaler credits convert into a globally recognized Master's via Woolf.

AM I ELIGIBLE

What background qualifies you for the program

Understand your starting point and where your newly acquired skills will take you after your journey with Scaler.

Profession / background

- An Engineering / IT / Maths background
- Working engineers with at least 1 year coding experience

The program is built for

- Early-Career Software Engineers & Full Stack Developers
- Data Engineers, Backend Engineers & Platform Engineers
- Solutions Engineers, Technical Consultants, SDETs & Implementation Engineers
- Senior Engineers, Tech Leads & Architects

AI-NATIVE CURRICULUM

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Module Name	Core/Elective	Duration
The FDE Launchpad – Role, SQL & the Legacy Data Problem	Core	1.25 Months
The Ingestion Pipeline – Production Python	Core	1.25 Months
The Platform Backend – Orders, Payments & Real-Time	Core	1.75 Months
The Ops Dashboard – React, TypeScript & Real-Time UI	Core	1 Month
The New Ask – Production RAG for Customer Support	Core	1 Month
From Answering to Acting – Agents & Enterprise Integration	Core	1.25 Months
The Scale Question – System Design for Black Friday	Core	1.25 Months
Scaling the AI Layer – Enterprise AI Architecture	Core	1 Month
Prepping the Ground – Linux, Networking & Shell	Core	1 Month
Containerizing Meridian – Docker & Kubernetes	Core	1.25 Months
Going Live – AWS Production Deployment with Terraform	Elective	2.25 Months
Making It Bulletproof – Reliability, HA & Disaster Recovery	Elective	1 Month
Enterprise Sign-Off – Security Hardening & Incident Response	Elective	0.75 Month
Capstone & Hiring Readiness – New Client, Full Simulation	Elective	1 Month

**Want to take
a deeper dive
into our
curriculum?**

Click Here 

MEET OUR INSTRUCTORS

Learn from the Experts

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**OUR EXPERT TROOPERS WILL
GO THE EXTRA MILE WITH YOU!**



Anshuman Singh

Co-Founder, **SCALER** , Ex- **facebook**

Anshuman Singh is the Co-Founder of Scaler and a two-time ACM ICPC world finalist. He was one of the founding team members of Facebook Messenger and worked directly with Mark Zuckerberg on product development.



Shivank Agarwal

Ex-  Microsoft

Senior V.P., Data Science at Scaler
Ex-Senior Software Development Manager,
Microsoft
Ex-Engineering Manager, Inmobi
Ex-Software Development Manager, Oracle



Naman Bhalla

Ex- 

Ex-Google, Naman Bhalla is Scaler's finest instructor. He secured global rank 135 at Google's Kickstart Round D, and 37th rank at ACM ICPC Kanpur Regionals, 2019-20. Naman is proficient in Spring, React, Redis, Kafka, and Flask. Currently, he is heading and building Scaler Topics from scratch.



Kshitij Mishra

Ex-Software Engineer,  snapdeal

Kshitij Mishra is an ex-Software Engineer II at Snapdeal and an ex-Lead Software Engineer at InterviewBit. He pursued his Bachelor's in Computer Science & Engineering from IIIT Hyderabad and is currently heading the team of Instructors at Scaler.



Utkarsh Gupta

Ex- , Germany

An ex-Googler in Germany, Utkarsh is a master at Codeforces and a 6-star coder at CodeChef. He secured AIR 1 in Google Hash Code 2019. Skilled in core Java, C, C++, Object Oriented Programming, Boolean Algebra, and Mathematical Analysis. At present, Utkarsh is a Team Manager and Instructor at InterviewBit/Scaler.



Shubham Soni

Software Engineer, 

Shubham Soni is a Software Engineer at Google, Bengaluru, where he works on large-scale backend systems. He is an ex-Software Engineer at Intuit, an ex-engineer at Credit Suisse, and an ex-engineer at Veritas Technologies building a strong track record across fintech, investment banking, and enterprise software verticals.



Anurag Khanna

Software Engineer,  Microsoft

Anurag Khanna is a Software Engineer 2 at Microsoft, Noida, where he works on large-scale software systems. He is an ex-Software Development Engineer at Amazon and an ex-SDE at Cadence Design Systems, building a strong track record across product engineering, EDA, and cloud-scale platforms.



Umang Agrawal

Software Development Engineer,  amazon

Umang is a SDE-II at Amazon, where he drives incentives strategy for Everyday Essentials projected to account for 64% of total Amazon units sold by 2028. He is an ex-Software Engineer at Microsoft, where he built Agreements, a contract management solution within SharePoint and Word, from ideation to onboarding the first 10 enterprise customers.



Kunal Jindal

Ex-Software Engineer,  Microsoft

Kunal is a SDE-II at Atlassian, working on the Marketplace platform. He is an ex-Software Engineer II at Microsoft, where he was among the youngest SDE-IIs and one of the first members of the Cloud Operations + Innovations (CO+I) India team, responsible for data center planning and capacity delivery across Microsoft's cloud offerings.

MEET OUR MENTORS

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Navigate your career with 1:1 Mentorship

Get clarity on your career path and tackle every stage of your upskilling journey with 1:1 guidance. Our mentors will go all the way to help you with your queries— interview insights, placement assistance, and ensuring you forge ahead with the right guidance.



Subhadip Chanda, **databricks**

Staff Forward Deployed Engineer at Databricks, transforming ambitious data strategies into high-performing, real-world platforms. Author of practical literature for tech professionals.



Anu Sharma, **Palantir**

Forward Deployed Engineer at Palantir, connecting enterprise clients with software. She also has software engineering experience from top tech companies such as Google, Intuit and X



Prajna Vegesna, **Sarvam**

Forward Deployed AI Engineer at Sarvam AI, building full-stack AI products designed to serve India's population at scale. She bears deep experience in data science consulting, ML, and LLM-driven solutions.



Kalaiselvan Swamy, **axelerant**

Forward Deployed Engineer at Axelerant, transforming business challenges into scalable AI-based solutions with 16+ years of experience in software engineering, architecture and program leadership.

**Goutham Harsha, Google**

Goutham is currently a Tech Lead at Google, Switzerland. He has worked at Apple as a senior SWE and Microsoft as SDE-II. He has worked on several distributed systems including Azure Compute, Apple Music, and Google Borg.

**Udit Agarwal, Microsoft**

Udit is a Backend expert, who has worked with tech giants like Microsoft, Amazon, Adobe, and Directi. An IIIT Allahabad alumnus, he has worked and built Chat applications, e-commerce sites, cloud file systems, streaming systems, etc.

**Divya Karia, Google**

Divya has delivered multiple e2e projects, including the launch and ideation of Google Play and Google Ads. She has mentored several freshers and her expertise lies in backend development, Databases, Java, C++, Python, C#, AWS, Azure, Hadoop, etc.

**Vinod Kumar, facebook**

Vinod has worked at tech giants like Microsoft, and Amazon, currently, he is working as a backend Software Engineer II at Facebook, London. He is proficient in C#, Java, NodeJS, cloud computing, distributed systems, data structures and advanced algorithms.

SCALER SUPPORT

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Amp up your Career

With the right career support, you can make a real-world impact.
Fasten your seatbelts, we're going to accelerate your career.

Practice mock
interviews with
Industry Ninjas

Connect &
collaborate
with **20K+**
Scaler alumni

Access job
opportunities
from **600+**
partner
employers

Polish your resume,
LinkedIn Profile
& get the needed
placement assistance

SCALER SUPPORT

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Top Tech Companies Cherish
Our Alumni working at:

amazon

Microsoft

Walmart

Walmart Labs

paytm

Flipkart

Mindtree

gojek

MindTickle

CRED

AJIO

ATLASSIAN

Google

NETFLIX

facebook

SAMSUNG

Jio

Paysafe

ONEPLUS

DELHIVERY

CREDIT SUISSE

DUNZO

Goldman Sachs

QUALCOMM

media.net

zeta

Cognizant

Adobe

PhonePe

OLA

NVIDIA

Infosys

HCL

UBER

toppr

wakefit

HOW TO ENROLL?

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Unlock Your Gateway to Tech Giants

Invest in Scaler

Our payment plans include multiple easy financing options (No Cost EMI, Scholarships) that make Scaler accessible to everyone.

We offer a 2 weeks trial period and a money-back guarantee if you choose to drop out of the course.

Enrollment Process: Kickstart your journey



Hassle-free Registration

Make a new account on www.scaler.com or login using your social/ InterviewBit account



Quick Evaluation

Take a 30 min MCQ test (aptitude & basic coding questions) to find the ideal batch for you



Batch Allotment

Sign in to the recommended batch with our flexible payment options and start upskilling

Enroll Now ➔

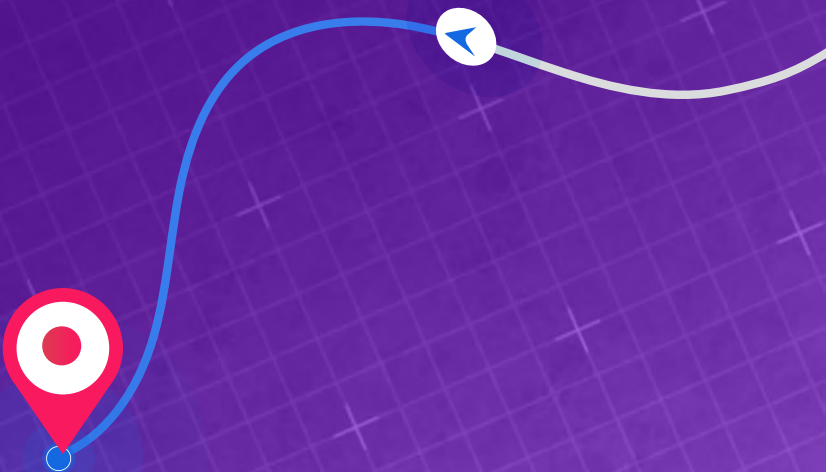
YOUR CERTIFICATES

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Showcase your skills on your resume

From Scaler





#CREATEIMPACT

THANK
YOU

Need more insights?

Speak with our Career Counsellor for a detailed
overview of Scaler

[Schedule a Call](#) ➤